

READ THE SCENE. PLAY THE INTENTION.

A marriage, before a meeting

Jane Austen · Chapter I

15 illustrated panels · 856 source words

[Character | placement; physicality; intention]

Read the cue before speaking. Keep the action through that speech.

\$\$Narrator | tone; pace\$\$

Return to the narrator. Character emotion does not carry over automatically.

Emphasis

Strike the selected word through contrast, pitch or duration. Do not default to shouting.

/ · // · ///

Micro-pause or breath · completed thought or voice switch · sustained silence.

> acceleration

Gather speed from this mark. Reset at the next // or voice cue.

... trailing release

Allow the voice to fade. Fry is optional, never required. An inserted ellipsis is a direction, not new source punctuation.

Mrs Bennet — Forward resonance; attention leans toward her listener. Urgency shifts into persuasion, objection and a bid for sympathy.**Mr Bennet** — Chest resonance without forcing depth. Economy of movement. Courtesy becomes a tool for evasion and teasing.**Narrator** — Conversational clarity and a level gaze. Let the contradiction carry the irony; do not announce every joke.

Use your own accent. No phonetic substitutions are imposed. Exact ages are not stated here; the adult voice choices are interpretation. Keep jaw and throat free.

AUSTEN / VOCAL SCORE

A fortune and a wife



Social expectations, visualized

\$\$Narrator | conversational; let certainty expose the joke\$\$

It is a truth **universally** acknowledged, / that a single man in possession of a good fortune, must be in want of a **wife**. // However little known the feelings or views of such a man may be on his first entering a neighbourhood, / this truth is so well fixed in the minds of the surrounding families, that he is considered the **rightful property** of some one or other of their daughters.

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AUSTEN / VOCAL SCORE

Netherfield is let



[Mrs Bennet | forward resonance; eager; lean in]

«My **dear** Mr. Bennet», //

\$\$Narrator | return to observation\$\$

said his lady to him one day, //

[Mrs Bennet | expect an answer]

«have you heard that Netherfield Park is let **at last**?» //

\$\$Narrator | return to observation\$\$

Mr. Bennet replied that he had not. //

[Mrs Bennet | brighten; correct him]

«But it **is**», //

\$\$Narrator | return to observation\$\$

returned she; //

[Mrs Bennet | share the scoop]

«for Mrs. Long has just been here, / and she told me **all** about it». //

\$\$Narrator | return to observation\$\$

Mr. Bennet made no answer.

///

AUSTEN / VOCAL SCORE

An invitation to speak



[Mrs Bennet | impatient; lean forward; challenge]

«Do you **not** want to know who has taken it?» //

\$\$Narrator | return to observation\$\$

cried his wife impatiently. //

[Mr Bennet | chest resonance; recline; permit without eagerness]

«**You** want to tell me, / and I have **no objection** to hearing it». //

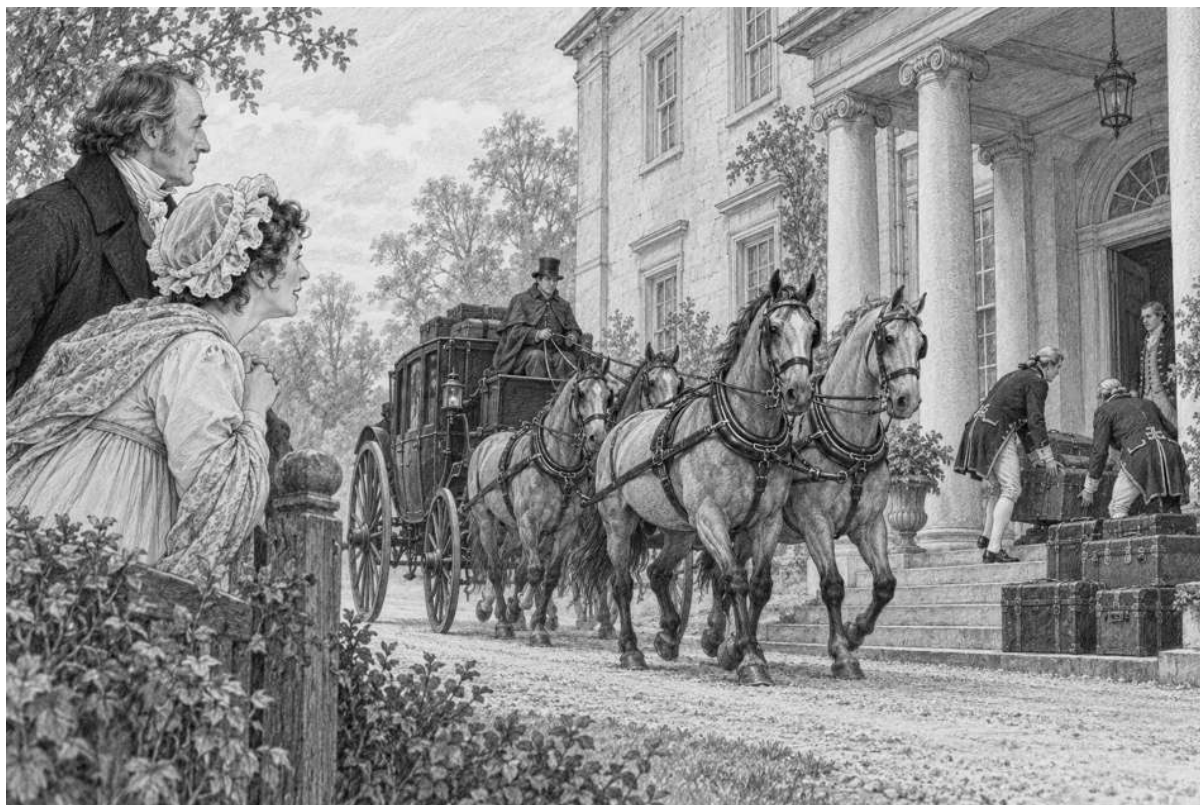
\$\$Narrator | return to observation\$\$

This was invitation enough.

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AUSTEN / VOCAL SCORE

The arrival



Mrs Bennet's report, imagined

[Mrs Bennet | forward resonance; gather momentum]

«Why, my dear, you must know, Mrs. Long says that Netherfield is taken by a young man of **large fortune** from the north of England; // > that he came down on Monday in a **chaise and four** to see the place, / and was so much delighted with it, that he agreed with Mr. Morris immediately; // that he is to take possession **before Michaelmas**, and some of his servants are to be in the house by the end of next week».

//

AUSTEN / VOCAL SCORE

Four thousand a year



Income imagined; a visual metaphor

[Mr Bennet | remain seated; ask plainly]

«What is his **name**?» //

[Mrs Bennet | answer promptly]

«**Bingley**». //

[Mr Bennet | test the premise]

«Is he **married** or **single**?» //

[Mrs Bennet | delighted; smile; sell the opportunity]

«Oh! **single**, my dear, to be sure! // A single man of large fortune; / **four or five thousand** a year. // What a fine thing for **our girls**!»

//

AUSTEN / VOCAL SCORE

The marriage plan



[Mr Bennet | slight head tilt; feign incomprehension]

«**How** so? / How can it affect **them**?» //

[Mrs Bennet | set feet; reclaim his attention]

«My dear **Mr. Bennet**», //

\$\$Narrator | return to observation\$\$

replied his wife, //

[Mrs Bennet | press the obvious conclusion]

«how can you be so **tiresome**! // You must know that I am thinking of his **marrying** one of them».

//

AUSTEN / VOCAL SCORE

The required visit



A visit imagined

[Mr Bennet | still face; probe her assumption]

«Is that **his design** in settling here?» //

[Mrs Bennet | release an exhale; dismiss, then persuade]

«**Design!** nonsense, how can you talk so! // > But it is very likely that he may fall in love with one of them, / and therefore you **must visit** him as soon as he comes».

//

AUSTEN / VOCAL SCORE

A compliment with teeth



[Mr Bennet | chest resonance; slight smile; bait with courtesy]

«I see **no occasion** for that. // You and the girls may go, or **you** may send them **by themselves**, / which perhaps will be still better, for as you are as handsome as any of them, / Mr. Bingley may like you the **best** of the party».

//

AUSTEN / VOCAL SCORE

Five daughters



[Mrs Bennet | smile, then settle; accept the compliment]

«My dear, you **flatter** me. // I certainly have had my share of beauty, but I do not pretend to be any thing extraordinary **now**. // When a woman has **five grown up daughters**, / she ought to give over thinking of her own beauty». //

[Mr Bennet | let the smile disappear; underplay the barb]

«In such cases, a woman has **not often** much beauty to think of».

//

AUSTEN / VOCAL SCORE

The rules of visiting



[Mrs Bennet | turn back to him; restore the objective]

«But, my dear, you **must indeed go** and see Mr. Bingley when he comes into the neighbourhood». //

[Mr Bennet | remain at ease; withhold agreement]

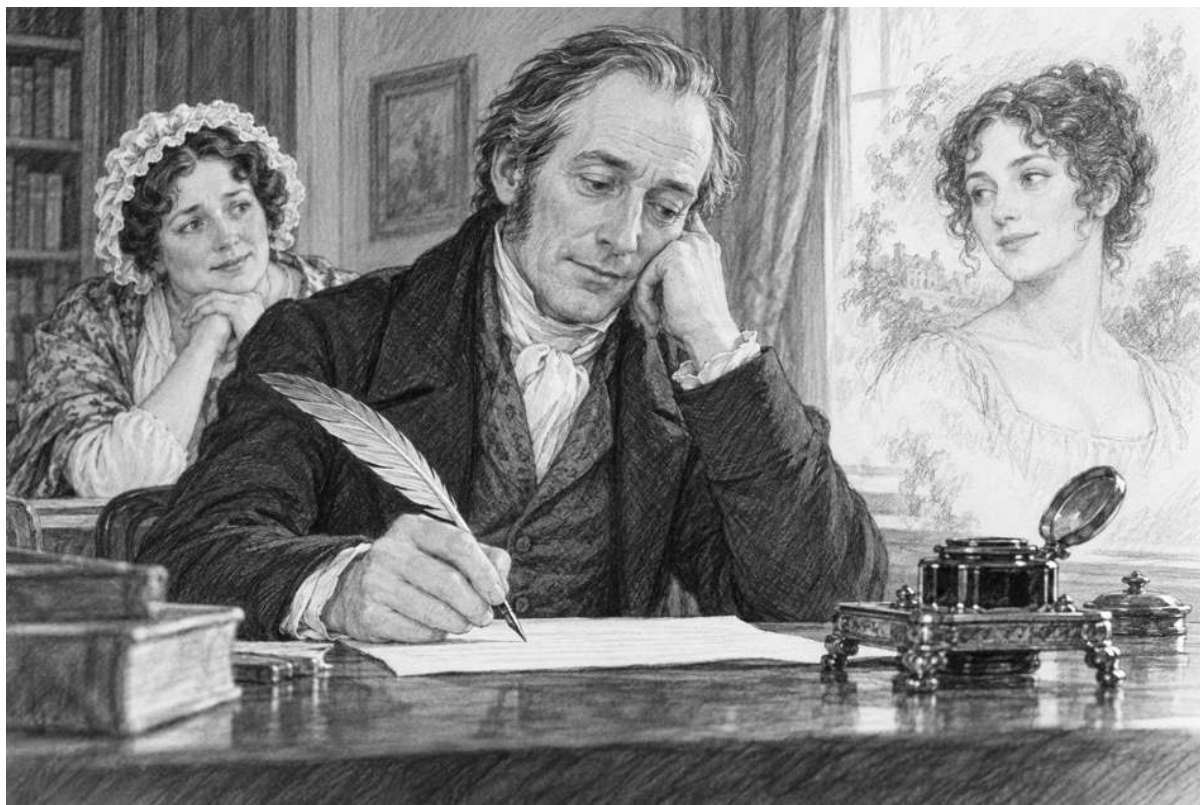
«It is **more** than I engage for, / I assure you». //

[Mrs Bennet | lean in; appeal, then apply pressure]

«But consider **your daughters**. // Only think what an **establishment** it would be for one of them. // Sir William and Lady Lucas are **determined** to go, / merely on that account, for in general you know they visit no new comers. // > Indeed you must go, for it will be **impossible** for us to visit him if you do not». //

AUSTEN / VOCAL SCORE

A word for Lizzy



The proposed letter, imagined

[Mr Bennet | courteous smile; offer an absurd compromise]

«You are **over scrupulous**, surely. // I dare say Mr. Bingley will be very glad to see you; / and I will send a few lines by you to assure him of my **hearty consent** to his marrying which ever he chuses of the girls; // though I must throw in a good word for **my little Lizzy**».

//

AUSTEN / VOCAL SCORE

The favourite daughter



[Mrs Bennet | indignant; straighten; block the preference]

«I desire you will do **no such thing**. // Lizzy is not a bit better than the others; / and I am sure she is not half so handsome as **Jane**, nor half so good humoured as **Lydia**. // But you are **always** giving her the preference». //

[Mr Bennet | dismiss with an even tone]

«They have **none** of them much to recommend them», //

\$\$Narrator | return to observation\$\$

replied he; //

[Mr Bennet | soften on Lizzy; reveal preference]

«they are **all** silly and ignorant like other girls; // but Lizzy has something more of **quickness** than her sisters».

//

AUSTEN / VOCAL SCORE

My poor nerves



[Mrs Bennet | wounded; draw shoulders inward; seek sympathy]

«Mr. Bennet, how can you abuse **your own children** in such a way? // You take **delight** in vexing me. // You have no compassion for my **poor nerves**».

///

AUSTEN / VOCAL SCORE

Twenty years of nerves



[Mr Bennet | composed posture; feign solicitude]

«You mistake me, my dear. // I have a **high respect** for your nerves. // They are my **old friends**. / I have heard you mention them with consideration these last **twenty years** at least». //

[Mrs Bennet | release the breath; ask to be understood]

«Ah, / you do not know what I **suffer ...**».

//

AUSTEN / VOCAL SCORE

The business of her life



[Mr Bennet | relaxed chest resonance; extend the tease]

«But I hope you will get over it, / and live to see **many** young men of **four thousand** a year come into the neighbourhood». //

[Mrs Bennet | face him; return to the obstacle]

«It will be **no use** to us, if twenty such should come, / since you **will not visit** them». //

[Mr Bennet | slight smile; land the impossible promise]

«Depend upon it, my dear, / that when there are **twenty**, / I will visit them **all**». //

\$\$Narrator | release character voices; observe without sneering\$\$

Mr. Bennet was so odd a mixture of quick parts, sarcastic humour, reserve, and caprice, / that the experience of **three and twenty years** had been insufficient to make his wife understand his character. // Her mind was **less difficult** to develope. // She was a woman of mean understanding, little information, and uncertain temper. // When she was discontented she fancied herself nervous. // The business of her life was to **get her daughters married**; / its solace was **visiting and news**.

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INTERPRETATION / TRANSPARENCY

What this edition preserves

Text coverage

All 856 words of the supplied chapter body are preserved in order. The split opening “I t” and spellings such as “chuses” and “develope” are retained. The opening split is an extraction artifact: read it as “It.”

Performance choices

Bold focus, vocal placement, posture and pacing are proposed interpretations. They are not Austen’s directions or a claim that actors share one universal scoring standard. Ellipsis here indicates a trailing release; it does not require vocal fry.

Artwork choices

Fifteen generated graphite-style illustrations accompany fifteen panels. Coins, portraits and the imagined letter are visual interpretations, not additional events claimed by the chapter. Physical character designs are casting choices.

Mechanical checks

The source spans reconstruct the supplied chapter exactly. Emphasis and inserted pause marks round-trip against those spans. A separate visible ellipsis after “suffer” is an added performance direction. Every panel has an image.

Reference supplied by you

How to Draw a Graphic Novel — Balthazar Pagani, Marco Maraggi and Otto Gabos. I consulted the publisher’s description, not the full book. No artwork from that book is reproduced.

Production review

TypeSafe reviewed the annotation rules without receiving the chapter text. Its output is advisory; source reconstruction and page inspection are separate checks. This PDF revises Chapter I, not the entire novel.

[Publisher reference ↗](#)